



THE FIGHT FOR AMERICA'S FAMILIES

Exposing the Corruption in Family Courts and CPS.

They took my kids. They tried to silence me. They WON'T.

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 11

GEORGIA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Georgia's family courts and child-welfare system.

54

GEORGIA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 82
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 16 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED
APRIL 26, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
24 OF 159

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

GEORGIA AT A GLANCE.

Across 54 Georgia families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 82 53 of 54 families reported child counts	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$20,000 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 16 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 46.3% 29.6% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 54	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.5	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 53 of 54	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 24

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Georgia families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](#)

02

THE COST OF GEORGIA FAMILY COURT

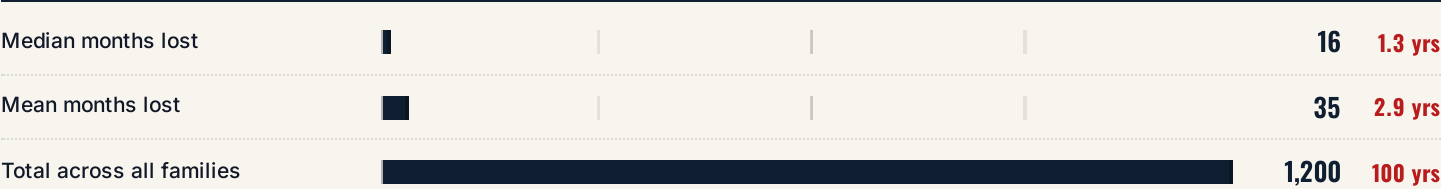
Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	39	\$20,000	\$79,487	\$3,100,000
Lost Wages	33	\$10,000	\$83,872	\$2,767,786
Other Court Fees	21	\$0	\$2,142	\$44,975
Therapy / Evaluations	33	\$2,000	\$3,358	\$110,800
Reunification Services	22	\$0	\$2,868	\$63,100
GAL Fees	26	\$0	\$5,019	\$130,500
Asset Loss ¹	33	\$30,000	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$62,000	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$30,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS



03 WHO IS REPORTING · GEORGIA

Most families documenting in Georgia are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		21	39%
Not provided		20	37%
Case closed: within last 2 years		7	13%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		4	7%
I am currently in an active case (progress is being made)		1	2%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only		24	44%
Both Family Court and CPS		20	37%
Unknown		6	11%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		3	6%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		13	24%
6 months – 1 year		11	20%
3 – 5 years		9	17%
5 – 10 years		7	13%
Over 10 years		5	9%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		17	31%
Visitation Only		12	22%
Children in Foster Care		9	17%
50/50 Joint		6	11%
Full Custody		5	9%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Catoosa		4	7%
Gwinnett		3	6%
Stephens		3	6%
Barrow		2	4%
Fulton		2	4%
Walker		1	2%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		19	35%
Other: (Short answer)		10	19%
High Conflict Divorce		6	11%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		4	7%
Environmental/Poverty-Related (Lack of housing, utilities, etc.)		2	4%

05 PARENT VOICES — GEORGIA

Quotes appear as submitted. Long submissions are trimmed with [...] to fit the page; the full unedited quote is available in the online version of this report.



This crooked system paints a false picture of scarcity, and then throws a meaty bone between two parties who used to care about each other, profiting from them tearing each other apart over it. My wife and I are kind people who love Jesus and love our kids. That hasn't helped [...]

— JOSHUA

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Through false statements, unlawful actions, and complete disregard for due process, this system tore my family apart and deprived me of irreplaceable time with my children. What they took from us cannot be measured or undone.

— GEORGIA PARENT · SAMANTHA

MORE VOICES FROM GEORGIA

My children have trauma and anxiety that never existed until DFCS was involved. Behavior issues now. My 4 year old son started wetting bed

— HALEY

Severed Mother son bond on zero facts all false allegations. Abuse of Power. My son is a weapon in family court and continues abuse.

— RHIANNON

Destroyed my whole life my kids are acting out violently towards each other mental health issues

— KELIA

It took an active and involved father away from a child's life and enabled the court to abuse a child with its default "legal" rules

— ANDY

My children were ripped away from me. Where they were going was planned long before court even happened. I wasn't given time to call family, they were going with my middle girls dad whom has 4 pending child abuse charges and battery. My 6 month old came home after 5 weeks with [...]

— APRIL

Taken precious moments that my children and I can never get back. Time cannot be reversed.

— ERIN

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Ripped up a family that made me have purpose life with my 6 babies

— JOANNA

They allowed us to not be one. my kids have no education and do not know there real family who love and miss them.

— KARA

They have destroyed any security we once had in the Georgia medical system.

— PATRICIA

Destroyed my entire being inside and out. Made my kids think im crazy and dont love them. We lost all hope, trust, love and time. My kids didnt get to meet so many people who wanted and missed all the love and what family actually is.

— SAMANTHA

It has destroyed my families future in a few short months that I have worked decades trying to recover from prior bad actors in my life.

— LARRY

Destroyed my rights to be a mother to my only child.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ripped apart our bond, our loving relationship, our ability to be in each others lives, caused irreparable harm and emotional trauma to us all

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has completely ripped our family apart!!

— JENNIFER

Ignored mental health, , and financial abuse

— JENNA

Destroyed this family. We will never be the same or trust anyone ever again.

— BRANDON

My daughter lost her mom, 3 Siblings and suffered psychological trauma with educational disabilities and no medical care for a year

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Crying, willing to share by phone.

— HEIDI

Destroyed my family. Caused significant harm to my children. Smeared my name. Lost all of the money that was left to me from where my husband died overseas. Money that was left to take care of my children was lost to this.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has completely ripped our family apart!!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It is caused three years of excruciatingly, painful heartbreak for my children for me

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system turned my child's abuser into the victim and ripped she and I apart. I became the villain that the community, friends, and even some of my family turned against because he seemed like such a nice guy. I was victimized by the system. My child was and is victimized by [...]

— AMANDA

This has almost killed me, mentally and physically. I have PTSD from it.

— DEBANIE

Destroyed my child's ability to feel protected and loved.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has mentally ruined my children's sense of safety, they trust nobody, my baby screens every time he has to leave, we get treated like trash and belittled and never get to speak for ourselves even when they are blatantly lying. Ever time they give me a finish line [...]

— AMANDA

The Gwinnett County Court system kidnapped my daughter.

— JENNA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Ruined the innocence of our child and ruined my life

— DOUG

The court never held the habitual absconding mother accountable to visitation violations.

— STEPHEN

Changed the entire dynamics of our entire life.

— KORTNEY

The system ignores true parental alienation. The system is broken and only relies on fast talking attorneys who only present one side of the information. Judges that are biased and small towns that probably have connections with specific families. This has robbed me of my mother [...]

— CHER

Tore my family apart, cause generational trauma for years to come. My two children did not get to grow up together for the first three years of my youngest son's life, and that we faced challenges of building proper relationships, like siblings should naturally be able to do. I [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Attempting to systematically deteriorate if not destroy a pre-existing full-time loving bond between a daughter of a tender age and her father through the state sanctioned licensing of paternal rights -- GA is the last of 50 states to still require un-wed fathers to formally beg [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Medical coercion, violation of religious beliefs, covering up group home crimes, everything has been crooked including my public pretender

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have ripped our ggbabies away from our entire family with not a scared of evidence of anything. I had temp custody of the oldest girl's when she was a baby.Used a my innocence of how the system worked when they returned her to parents.Due to a lie by caseworker and used [...]

— LARAINÉ

“Despite the family court’s attempts to break me and the threats against my safety, I stand unwavering and unbowed, a testament to resilience and the indomitable spirit of a mother.”

— HANNAH

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

Torn us apart for being poor

— STEPHANIE

From the day I called the police for help, every single person that came in contact with my child and I, from law enforcement all the way to the church and everything in between has failed us. The system aided our abuser, opening the door for him to continue his path of abuse [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This situation has resulted in irreparable harm. I have been deprived of time and the ability to protect my child. My child has endured immense suffering.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

40 Georgia parents submitted ranked quotes. 40 appear in this report; the remainder are available at standwithmeg.com/ga.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Georgia report comes from Georgia respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Georgia — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 54 Georgia families reporting here are not the universe of Georgia families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – April 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 5 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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